OFFICE OF THE UNIVERSITY REGISTRAR & ACADEMIC SENATE

ACADEMIC QUALITY ASSURANCE, EXAMINATIONS & STUDENT WELFARE GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK

MEDICAL DOCUMENTATION STANDARDS AND STUDENT WELFARE GUIDELINES

Document Code:	**POL-MED-WF-04**	**Version & Status:**	Version 3.5 (2025 Mandatory Senate Revision)
Effective Date:	01 January 2025	**Supersedes:**	Section 5.5 of Legacy Student Handbook (HBK-ACAD-PR-05 v1.8, 2023)
Approving Body:	University Senate, Chief Medical Officer & Student Welfare Directorate	**Linked Policies:**	POL-ACAD-EX-01, POL-ACAD-AT-02, POL-ACAD-CW-03, HBK-ACAD-PR-05

SECTION 1: EVIDENTIARY GOVERNANCE, SCOPE, AND CLINICAL BOUNDARIES

Clause 1.1 (Administrative Purpose and Non-Diagnostic Boundary): This policy defines the mandatory legal, clinical, and administrative standards for all medical documentation submitted by students in support of examination deferrals (`POL-ACAD-EX-01`), attendance condonation (`POL-ACAD-AT-02`), coursework extensions (`POL-ACAD-CW-03`), or medical intercalation (`HBK-ACAD-PR-05`). University administrative staff and advisory systems evaluate medical certificates strictly for regulatory compliance and do not perform medical diagnosis or clinical treatment.

Clause 1.2 (Supersession of Legacy 2023 Ayurvedic Certificate Rule): Effective 01 January 2025, Clause 2.2 of this policy supersedes Clause 5.5 of the 2023 Student Handbook (`HBK-ACAD-PR-05` v1.8). Private, unverified Ayurvedic medical certificates are no longer accepted directly by academic departments; Ayurvedic certificates are admissible **only** if issued by a registered Government Ayurvedic Teaching Hospital and countersigned by the University Chief Medical Officer (CMO) within **three (3) working days**.

DOCUMENTATION GOVERNANCE DEFINITIONS (PART A)

- **SLMC Registration Number:** Mandatory 5-digit registration credential issued by the Sri Lanka Medical Council to licensed Western medical practitioners.
- **Form MED-04-CLR (CMO Clearance Slip):** Official verification certificate issued by the University Medical Center (UMC) confirming the authenticity of a student's medical dossier.
- **Contemporaneous Assessment:** A clinical examination conducted during the active phase of illness, never retroactively after recovery.

DOCUMENTATION GOVERNANCE DEFINITIONS (PART B)

- **Inpatient Hospitalization Dossier:** Mandatory bundle for hospital stays >= 24 hours: Admission/Discharge Ticket, Ward Consultant Summary, and Diagnostic Reports.
- **University Medical Center (UMC):** Located at Building B, Ground Floor; sole authority empowered to validate external medical certificates.
- **Category-A Misconduct:** Submission of forged, altered, or fabricated medical certificates, carrying mandatory suspension penalties.

SECTION 2: AUTHORIZED MEDICAL PRACTITIONERS AND CREDENTIAL STANDARDS

Clause 2.1 (Recognized Western Medical Practitioners): To be legally admissible for academic consideration, a medical certificate must be issued by one of the following recognized practitioners:

Sub-clause 2.1.1 (a): The University Chief Medical Officer (CMO) or resident Campus Medical Officers at the University Medical Center (UMC);

Sub-clause 2.1.1 (b): A Consultant Physician, Surgeon, or Medical Officer attached to a Sri Lankan Government Hospital, Teaching Hospital, or Ministry of Health institution;

Sub-clause 2.1.1 (c): A licensed Western Medical Practitioner holding an active, verifiable registration with the **Sri Lanka Medical Council (SLMC)** practicing at a registered private hospital or clinic (for international occurrences, equivalent national statutory registration such as GMC/AMC is required).

Clause 2.2 (Strict Conditions for Indigenous / Ayurvedic Medical Certificates): Certificates issued by Ayurvedic or traditional practitioners are admissible **strictly and exclusively** where the certificate is issued by a **Government Ayurvedic Teaching or Base Hospital** bearing the official hospital seal AND is presented by the student to the University Medical Center (UMC) within **three (3) working days** for clinical review and countersignature by the University CMO. Private dispensary Ayurvedic notes are summarily rejected.

Clause 2.3 (Conflict of Interest and Backdated Certificates): Medical certificates issued by a practitioner who is an immediate family member or close relative of the student are strictly invalid. Furthermore, retrospective certificates where the date of clinical consultation occurs *after* the period of claimed illness are inadmissible.

Table 2.1: Admissibility Matrix for Medical Practitioners and Clinical Certificates (2025 Rules)

Practitioner / Institution Type	Required Credential Stamp	Admissibility for Missed Final Exam (POL-ACAD-EX-01)	Admissibility for Coursework / Attendance	Mandatory UMC / CMO Verification Rule
University Medical Center (CMO)	Official UMC Stamp + CMO Signature	FULLY ADMISSIBLE	FULLY ADMISSIBLE	Immediate issuance of Form MED-04-CLR during visit
Government / Teaching Hospital	Official Ward Seal + Consultant/MO SLMC No.	FULLY ADMISSIBLE (Gold Standard)	FULLY ADMISSIBLE	Submit Discharge Ticket to UMC within 5 working days for Form MED-04-CLR
Registered Private Hospital (Inpatient)	Hospital Corporate Seal + Consultant SLMC No.	FULLY ADMISSIBLE	FULLY ADMISSIBLE	Must include Discharge Summary + Lab/Pharmacy bills; UMC verification within 5 working days
Private GP / Outpatient Clinic (MBBS)	Doctor's Official Seal + 5-Digit SLMC No.	ADMISSIBLE (Only with supporting prescription/lab receipts)	ADMISSIBLE	CMO inspects clinical severity at UMC within 5 working days
Govt. Ayurvedic Teaching Hospital	Official Govt. Hospital Seal + Reg. No.	CONDITIONAL (Requires CMO Endorsement)	CONDITIONAL (Requires CMO Endorsement)	Must be countersigned by University CMO within 3 working days (2025 Rule)
Private Ayurvedic / Homeopathic / Relative	Any private traditional stamp	STRICTLY INADMISSIBLE (Rejected)	STRICTLY INADMISSIBLE (Rejected)	Revoked under 2025 Policy (Supersedes 2023 Handbook Clause 5.5)

SECTION 3: MANDATORY DOCUMENT CHECKLIST FOR INPATIENT HOSPITALIZATION vs. OUTPATIENT ILLNESS

Clause 3.1 (Six Mandatory Elements on Every Medical Certificate): Every medical certificate must legibly display: (1) Student's full legal name and University Registration Number; (2) Exact date and time of clinical examination; (3) Clinical diagnosis or ICD-10 medical category; (4) Explicit statement that the student was *'Medically Unfit for Academic / Examination Duties'*; (5) Exact inclusive start date and end date of medical unfitness; and (6) Practitioner's signature, official rubber stamp, SLMC Registration Number, and clinic contact telephone.

Clause 3.2 (Enhanced Dossier for Inpatient Hospitalization >= 3 Days, Including 10-Day Hospital Stays): Where a student is hospitalized as an inpatient (for example, a **10-day hospitalization** impacting exams, attendance, and assignments), a single one-page doctor's note is insufficient. The student must compile and submit the complete **Inpatient Hospitalization Dossier** comprising all items listed in Table 3.1.

Table 3.1: Mandatory Medical Documentation Checklist by Student Case Type

Document Item	Short Outpatient Illness (1–3 Days)	Missed Final Exam (Outpatient)	Inpatient Hospitalization (e.g., 10-Day Stay)	Purpose & Verification Office
1. SLMC Medical Certificate	Mandatory (Original)	Mandatory (Original)	Mandatory (or Ward Medical Certificate)	Proves clinical unfitness dates (Checked by UMC)
2. Hospital Admission & Discharge Ticket	Not Applicable	If admitted to Emergency Treatment Unit (ETU)	MANDATORY (Must show Admission Date & Discharge Date)	Proves exact 10-day inpatient confinement & triggers post-discharge deadline clock
3. Consultant Clinical / Diagnostic Summary	Optional	Mandatory (Lab report / Prescription copy)	MANDATORY (Signed by Ward Consultant / Registrar)	Verifies clinical severity & recovery period required
4. UMC CMO Clearance Slip (Form MED-04-CLR)	Required for Tier-2 Extension / Condonation	MANDATORY	MANDATORY (Issued at UMC Counter, Building B)	Prerequisite before Exams Division or Faculty Office accepts forms
5. Academic Application Forms	Form EXT-03A or Form ATT-02A	Form EC-01	Consolidated Bundle: Form EC-01 + Form ATT-02A/B + Form EXT-03C + Form PRG-05-CASE	Submitted to respective administrative counters within 5 working days of discharge

SECTION 4: TWO-STAGE SUBMISSION WORKFLOW, RESPONSIBLE OFFICES, AND LOCATIONS

Clause 4.1 (Stage 1 — Digital Portal Upload within 48 Hours): Within 48 hours of missing an examination or requiring hospitalization support, the student (or next-of-kin if hospitalized) must upload clear PDF/JPEG scans of the preliminary medical admission note to the *Student Welfare & Academic Consideration Portal*.

Clause 4.2 (Stage 2 — Physical Verification at UMC and Routing to Administrative Counters within 5 Working Days): Within **five (5) working days** of the missed assessment (or within **5 working days of hospital discharge** for inpatient stays), the student must present the physical original documents to the **University Medical Center (UMC)** to obtain `Form MED-04-CLR`, and then distribute certified copies to the relevant offices detailed in Table 4.1.

Table 4.1: Directory of Responsible University Offices, Physical Locations, and Submission Deadlines

Administrative Step	Responsible Department / Office	Physical Campus Location & Email	Documents Submitted Here	Statutory Deadline
Step 1: Medical Authentication	University Medical Center (UMC) — Chief Medical Officer	Building B, Ground Floor, Room B-04 (`umc@university.edu`)	Original Medical Certificate + Hospital Discharge Summary + Lab Reports	Within 5 working days of exam/discharge (3 days for Govt. Ayurvedic)
Step 2: Missed Final Exam Filing	Examinations Division (Registrar's Office)	Main Admin Block, Level 2, Counter 204 (`exams.welfare@university.edu`)	Form EC-01 + Original Form MED-04-CLR + Exam Timetable copy	Within 5 working days of exam (or 5 working days post-discharge)
Step 3: Attendance Condonation	Faculty Academic Administration Office (HoD / Dean)	Faculty Complex, Level 1, Room F-102 (`faculty.admin@university.edu`)	Form ATT-02A (70–79%) or Form ATT-02B (65–69%) + Copy of Form MED-04-CLR	Within 5 working days of return to classes (before Fri Week 14)
Step 4: Coursework Extension	Department Coursework Coordinator / Faculty EC Panel	LMS Extension Portal + Dept Office (`cw.support@university.edu`)	Form EXT-03A/B/C + Copy of Form MED-04-CLR + Hospital Discharge Ticket	24h prior to deadline (or within 3 working days post-discharge)
Step 5: Multi-Issue Case Coordination	Student Welfare & Academic Advisory Directorate	Student Center, Level 1, Suite 108 (`welfare@university.edu`)	Consolidated Case Form PRG-05-CASE (when Exam + Attendance + CW all affected)	Within 5 working days of hospital discharge

SECTION 5: MENTAL HEALTH SUPPORT, CONFIDENTIALITY, AND ACADEMIC MISCONDUCT PENALTIES

Clause 5.1 (Sensitive Diagnoses and Fast-Track Confidentiality): Where a student's medical condition involves sensitive psychiatric, reproductive, or chronic infectious diagnoses, the student may request a *Redacted Clinical Clearance (`Form MED-04-CONF`)* from the University CMO. Under this protocol, detailed clinical notes remain sealed at the UMC, and academic committees receive only the CMO's certified functional impact statement and unfitness dates.

Clause 5.2 (Zero-Tolerance Policy on Fraudulent Medical Documentation): The University conducts random verification audits with issuing hospitals and SLMC registries. Submitting a forged, altered, backdated, or purchased medical certificate constitutes a **Category-A Academic Misconduct Offense** resulting in: (a) immediate annulment of all module marks for the semester (`0% Fail`), (b) mandatory suspension for one academic year, and (c) permanent disciplinary notation.

POLICY CONFLICT & SUPERSESSION NOTICE (2025 vs. 2023 HANDBOOK)
Conflict Alert #5: Legacy Clause 5.5 of the 2023 Student Handbook (HBK-ACAD-PR-05 v1.8) states that private Ayurvedic medical certificates are accepted directly by academic departments without UMC verification. That rule is REVOKED under POL-MED-WF-04 v3.5 (2025) Clause 2.2. Only Government Ayurvedic Teaching Hospital certificates countersigned by the University CMO within 3 working days are valid.